01 / UNDERSTAND THE TASK

Chord Tone Recognition

Hear a chord. Then hear one note on its own.
Can you tell what that note does inside the chord?

What you are practising

You are learning to recognise the **root, third, fifth and seventh** of a chord by ear. These are the four roles a note can have in this quiz.

Why it helps

You can hear how a melody note fits a chord, follow bass lines more confidently and recognise chord sounds even when their notes are rearranged.

One question, in two sounds

Example: the question tells you this is a **Major 7th** chord.

FIRST · THE WHOLE CHORD

F	A	C	E
1 · root	3 · third	5 · fifth	7 · seventh

→

THEN · ONE NOTE

A

played on its own

A is the third of this chord, so choose **3**.

1	✓ 3	5	7

The four answer buttons

1
Root
The note the chord is named after.

3
Third
Helps give the chord its major or minor sound.

5
Fifth
A chord note that can also be lowered or raised.

7
Seventh
The fourth note added to the basic three-note chord.

The question gives you the chord type.
Your job is to identify the single note’s role. Choose a number, rather than a letter name or another chord type.

02 / KNOW WHAT CHANGES

What do #1–#6 mean?

The numbers identify different chord groups and arrangements. **All six quizzes use all twelve keys.**

Quiz	Chord group	Arrangement	Keys
#1	Five standard seventh-chord types	Root position	All 12
#2	Same five types as #1	1st, 2nd and 3rd inversions	All 12
#3	Six secondary seventh-chord types	Root position	All 12
#4	Same six types as #3	1st, 2nd and 3rd inversions	All 12
#5	Both groups combined: 11 types	Root position	All 12
#6	Same 11 types as #5	1st, 2nd and 3rd inversions	All 12

QUIZZES #1 & #2

The five standard types

- Major 7th
- Minor 7th
- Dominant 7th
- Minor 7(♭ 5) · half-diminished
- Diminished 7th

QUIZZES #3 & #4

The six secondary types

- Augmented 7th
- Minor-Major 7th
- Diminished-Major 7th
- Dominant 7(♭ 5)
- Major 7(♯5)
- Major 7(♭ 5)

F is an illustration, not a key restriction.

The worked examples in this guide use F to make comparisons easy. In every quiz, the same chord types also appear on other roots.

A useful way to work through the category

Work in pairs: **#1** → **#2**, then **#3** → **#4**. Finish with **#5** → **#6** to practise both chord groups together.

03 / UNDERSTAND INVERSIONS

Different positions. The same four roles.

An inversion rearranges the chord notes so a different note sits at the bottom. The root keeps its name and role.

One F major seventh chord, four arrangements

Read each row from lowest to highest. The highlighted F is always **1**.

Root position Root at the bottom	**F** 1	**A** 3	**C** 5	**E** 7
1st inversion Third at the bottom	**A** 3	**C** 5	**E** 7	**F** 1
2nd inversion Fifth at the bottom	**C** 5	**E** 7	**F** 1	**A** 3
3rd inversion Seventh at the bottom	**E** 7	**F** 1	**A** 3	**C** 5

1 does not mean “the lowest note.”

If the chord is A–C–E–F and the single note is F, the answer is still **1**. A is at the bottom, but the chord is named after F.

The chord type matters too

A lowered or raised note keeps its role. Read the chord type in the question before listening.

F major seventh

F · A · C · E

A is the third → choose **3**.
E is the seventh → choose **7**.

F minor seventh

F · A♭ · C · E♭

A♭ is still the third → choose **3**.
E♭ is still the seventh → choose **7**.

04 / YOUR LISTENING ROUTINE

One chord.
One note. One choice.

1 **Read the question**

Notice the chord type that is given, such as Major 7th or Minor 7th.

2 **Hear the whole chord**

Press Play. Get a sense of the full sound before focusing on the single note.

3 **Follow the note on its own**

Listen for where it belongs inside the chord. Replay the audio if you need to.

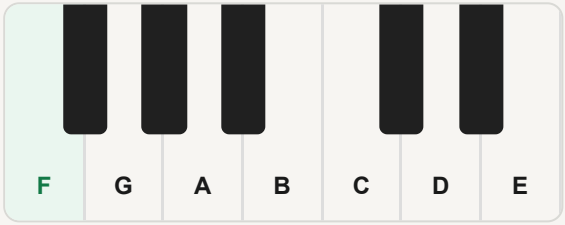
4 **Choose and submit**

Select 1, 3, 5 or 7. You can change your choice before pressing Submit Answer.

WORKED EXAMPLE

F major seventh

Chord: A–C–E–F
Single note: F



Answer: 1 · Root

The highlighted key shows the note's name. You answer its role in the chord.

A quick visual check

Use the written notes to check that the roles make sense. Then practise recognising those roles by sound in the quiz.

Chord	Notes, low to high	Single note	Answer
F major seventh	F · A · C · E	E	**7**
F minor seventh	A ♭ · C · E ♭ · F	A ♭	**3**
F dominant seventh	C · E ♭ · F · A	C	**5**

Before you move to the next quiz

- ✓ I can explain what 1, 3, 5 and 7 mean.
- ✓ I know the root may be above another chord note.
- ✓ I can use the chord type in the question to guide my listening.